NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Employee Hiring and Recruitment SOP

Standard operating procedure for workforce requests, candidate assessment, selection, offer management, and hiring records

Document ID	HR-SOP-001
Document Type	SOP
Access Scope	ADMIN_ONLY
Department	Human Resources
Version	1.0
Effective Date	04 November 2026
Process Owner	Human Resources Department
Classification	Confidential – Restricted Administrative Access

RESTRICTED – AUTHORIZED ADMINISTRATORS ONLY

This fictional demonstration SOP is created for the Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. OnBoardIQ environment. It supports controlled document-ingestion and retrieval testing and is not a formally approved hiring procedure or legal policy.

1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) describes the controlled process for requesting, approving, sourcing, assessing, selecting, and onboarding new employees at Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It is designed to promote consistent hiring decisions, clear accountability, fair candidate treatment, and secure handling of recruitment information.

- Ensure each vacancy is supported by a documented business need and approved headcount.
- Use consistent, role-related selection criteria and structured evaluation methods.
- Define responsibilities across hiring managers, Human Resources, interviewers, and approvers.
- Maintain accurate recruitment records while protecting candidate confidentiality.
- Provide candidates with timely and professional communication throughout the process.

2. Scope and Access Restriction

This SOP applies to permanent, fixed-term, and other employee hiring processes managed by Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It covers new positions, approved replacement hiring, internal applicants, and recruitment agency support where applicable.

- HR owns the recruitment process and maintains the official process records.
- Hiring managers define role requirements, assess candidates, and recommend selection.
- Interviewers evaluate candidates against agreed competencies and provide evidence-based feedback.
- Authorized approvers confirm headcount, compensation, and offer decisions within delegated authority.

Access restriction: This document uses ADMIN_ONLY. It is intended for authorized HR personnel and explicitly authorized administrators. Candidate records, interview feedback, compensation details, and approval evidence must be protected separately through appropriate role-based permissions.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Primary responsibilities
Hiring Manager	Raise the hiring request, define role outcomes and essential criteria, participate in interviews, and recommend a candidate.
Human Resources (HR)	Validate the request, coordinate sourcing and screening, schedule interviews, manage candidate communications, and maintain recruitment records.
Interview Panel	Assess candidates using agreed questions, competencies, and evaluation criteria; submit timely, factual feedback.
Department Head / Budget Owner	Confirm business need, team capacity, budget availability, and required approvals.
Authorized Approver	Approve headcount, compensation exceptions, and final offer terms within delegated authority.
IT / Workplace / Onboarding Teams	Prepare approved access, equipment, and joining arrangements after the candidate accepts the offer.

4. Recruitment Process Overview

Stage	Key activity	Primary owner
1. Workforce request	Submit role justification and hiring requisition.	Hiring Manager
2. Approval	Validate budget, headcount, and authorization.	Department Head / Approver
3. Role definition	Finalize job description and selection criteria.	Hiring Manager + HR
4. Sourcing	Publish vacancy and identify potential candidates.	HR
5. Screening	Review applications against essential criteria.	HR
6. Assessment	Conduct interviews and approved assessments.	Interview Panel
7. Selection	Consolidate evidence and recommend preferred candidate.	Hiring Manager + HR
8. Verification	Complete approved reference or background checks, where applicable.	HR
9. Offer	Approve and issue written offer; record acceptance.	HR + Approver
10. Handover	Transfer minimum necessary joining information to onboarding teams.	HR

5. Step 1 – Workforce Request and Requisition

The hiring manager must submit a recruitment requisition before HR begins external sourcing or commits to a candidate.

- State whether the request is for a new position, replacement, or temporary workforce need.
- Provide the proposed job title, department, reporting manager, work location, employment type, and expected start window.
- Describe the business need, expected responsibilities, role outcomes, and impact if the vacancy remains unfilled.
- Identify essential and desirable skills, experience, qualifications, and role-specific competencies.
- Provide the proposed compensation range or approved budget reference.
- Attach or reference the draft job description and proposed interview panel.

HR should return incomplete requests to the hiring manager for clarification. No job advertisement or candidate commitment should be made before the required approvals are recorded.

6. Step 2 – Review and Approval

HR and the relevant budget owner review the requisition for completeness, organizational fit, and authorization.

- Confirm that the role is included in the approved workforce plan or has a documented exception approval.
- Verify budget availability and the proposed compensation range.
- Confirm the reporting line, department, location, employment type, and headcount classification.
- Identify any conflicts of interest or special approval requirements.
- Record the decision, approver identity, date, and any conditions attached to approval.

HR must not proceed with recruitment activity that requires approval until the approval status is confirmed in the designated system.

7. Step 3 – Job Description and Selection Criteria

The hiring manager and HR jointly finalize a job description before sourcing begins. Criteria must be relevant to the actual responsibilities and seniority of the role.

- Include role purpose, key responsibilities, reporting relationship, and expected outcomes.
- Separate essential requirements from desirable qualifications or experience.
- Describe technical, functional, communication, collaboration, and problem-solving competencies as relevant.

- Define the assessment stages and the evidence each stage is expected to produce.
- Use clear, inclusive language and avoid unnecessary requirements that do not relate to job performance.
- Obtain hiring manager confirmation and retain the approved version with the requisition.

8. Step 4 – Candidate Sourcing and Job Advertising

- HR selects appropriate sourcing channels, which may include the company careers page, approved job portals, professional networks, employee referrals, or authorized recruitment agencies.
- Publish only the approved job description and compensation information authorized for disclosure.
- Include a clear application method, role location, employment type, and closing date where applicable.
- Use consistent vacancy identifiers to associate applications with the approved requisition.
- Ensure recruitment agencies receive written role requirements and confidentiality expectations.
- Do not share internal budgets, interview deliberations, or confidential workforce plans with external parties unless explicitly authorized.

9. Step 5 – Application Screening and Shortlisting

HR screens applications against the approved essential criteria and records the basis for moving candidates forward or closing their applications.

- Check relevant skills, experience, qualifications, and role-specific evidence provided by the applicant.
- Apply the same screening criteria to candidates applying for the same vacancy.
- Record screening outcomes using the approved status values or recruitment system workflow.
- Escalate unclear or borderline cases to the hiring manager for consistent interpretation.
- Avoid using protected characteristics or irrelevant personal information as selection criteria.
- Limit access to applicant resumes and contact details to personnel involved in the recruitment process.

10. Step 6 – Interview Planning and Candidate Assessment

HR coordinates a structured assessment plan with the hiring manager. The plan should be proportionate to the role and communicated to candidates in advance.

- Define interview stages, panel members, competencies, and expected duration.
- Prepare consistent core questions for candidates assessed at the same stage.
- Use practical exercises, technical tasks, case studies, or presentations only where relevant to the role.
- Explain the assessment format, preparation expectations, and any reasonable accessibility arrangements.
- Ensure interviewers understand confidentiality, conflicts of interest, and evidence-based evaluation expectations.

Candidate assessment records should distinguish observed evidence from personal impressions. Interviewers should not record irrelevant or discriminatory comments.

11. Step 7 – Interview Feedback and Evaluation

Each interviewer should submit feedback promptly after the interview using the approved evaluation template.

Evaluation area	Example evidence to record
Role knowledge	Accuracy and relevance of role-specific knowledge demonstrated.
Technical / functional capability	Approach, reasoning, quality of work, and practical skill demonstrated.
Problem solving	Ability to clarify a problem, assess options, and explain decisions.
Communication	Clarity, listening, structure, and ability to explain relevant concepts.
Collaboration	Examples of teamwork, feedback handling, and cross-functional work.

Evaluation area	Example evidence to record
Role alignment	Evidence that the candidate can meet the essential responsibilities and expectations.

- Use the same evaluation scale and definitions for candidates assessed at the same stage.
- Provide specific examples supporting positive and negative assessments.
- Flag missing evidence rather than assuming capability or lack of capability.
- HR checks that required feedback has been submitted before a final recommendation is recorded.

12. Step 8 – Selection Decision

The hiring manager reviews the available evidence with HR and recommends the candidate whose demonstrated capabilities best match the approved role requirements.

- Compare candidates against the agreed criteria rather than introducing new criteria late in the process.
- Consider all relevant interview and assessment evidence, including any role-related concerns.
- Document the selection rationale and any material risks or development needs.
- Record the outcome for each candidate using the approved recruitment workflow.
- Escalate unresolved conflicts of interest, inconsistent feedback, or material concerns to HR.
- Obtain the required final selection approval before communicating an offer.

13. Step 9 – Reference and Background Verification

Where permitted, required for the role, and appropriately disclosed, HR coordinates reference or background verification using approved providers and procedures.

- Obtain any required candidate notice, consent, or authorization before checks begin.
- Use checks that are relevant and proportionate to the role and applicable requirements.
- Verify information only through approved sources and handle discrepancies fairly.
- Restrict verification results to authorized personnel and store them separately where required.
- Escalate material discrepancies to the designated HR authority before an employment decision.
- Do not treat an unverified allegation or irrelevant personal information as a conclusive finding.

14. Step 10 – Compensation Approval and Offer Issuance

- HR prepares the offer using the approved role, compensation range, employment type, reporting line, work location, and proposed start date.
- Confirm that compensation and any variable pay, benefits, allowances, or special terms have the required approvals.
- Obtain written approval for exceptions to the approved compensation range or standard terms.
- Issue the offer through an authorized channel and specify the response deadline.
- Record the offer version, issue date, acceptance status, and any approved changes.
- Do not promise unapproved compensation, title, promotion, remote-work terms, or benefits.
- If the candidate declines or negotiations fail, record the outcome and agree whether another candidate should be considered.

15. Step 11 – Offer Acceptance and Pre-Joining Handover

After written acceptance, HR coordinates the transition from recruitment to onboarding while limiting the information shared to what each team needs.

- Confirm acceptance and the agreed joining date in the recruitment system.
- Send the candidate the approved pre-joining instructions and required documentation list.

- Create or update the employee onboarding record using verified information.
- Notify the relevant manager and authorized onboarding, IT, and workplace contacts.
- Share only the minimum necessary personal information for account creation, equipment, and workplace preparation.
- Keep recruitment evaluation notes and sensitive verification results restricted to authorized HR users.

16. Candidate Communication and Experience

- Acknowledge applications through the approved channel where operationally feasible.
- Provide clear instructions and reasonable notice for interview scheduling or changes.
- Communicate material process updates without disclosing confidential internal deliberations.
- Notify unsuccessful candidates respectfully once the decision is finalized and approved.
- Do not make misleading statements about role security, compensation, timelines, or selection likelihood.
- Direct candidate questions about personal data handling to the designated HR contact.

17. Recruitment Records, Confidentiality, and Access

Recruitment records may contain resumes, contact details, interview notes, assessment results, reference information, compensation proposals, and approval history. These records must be protected throughout their lifecycle.

- Store official records only in approved HR or recruitment systems.
- Apply least-privilege access and review access when recruitment responsibilities change.
- Do not forward candidate information to personal email accounts or store it in unmanaged personal drives.
- Use approved secure channels when sharing candidate information with interviewers or authorized providers.
- Follow the approved retention schedule and applicable privacy and employment requirements.
- Dispose of records securely when retention is no longer required.
- Report suspected unauthorized access, loss, or disclosure through the designated incident process.

OnBoardIQ retrieval rule: This SOP is classified as ADMIN_ONLY. Retrieval must be restricted to authorized administrators by backend authorization and metadata filtering. A document's ADMIN_ONLY label must not be treated as a substitute for enforcing access control in the application.

18. Exceptions, Escalations, and Process Deviations

- Any exception to the standard process must be documented with a reason, owner, risk assessment, and required approval.
- Urgent hiring requests must still meet mandatory headcount, budget, and offer authorization requirements.
- Suspected discrimination, conflict of interest, candidate data misuse, or process manipulation must be escalated to HR leadership.
- If a required approval or verification step cannot be completed, HR must pause the affected stage and seek direction from the authorized approver.
- Material deviations should be reviewed after completion to determine whether process controls need improvement.

19. Process Checklist

Control point	Evidence required before proceeding
Requisition	Complete role request, business justification, and vacancy identifier.
Authorization	Recorded headcount, budget, and required approvals.
Role definition	Approved job description and objective selection criteria.
Sourcing	Approved advertisement and authorized sourcing channels.
Screening	Documented shortlist decisions against essential criteria.
Assessment	Interview plan, structured feedback, and assessment records.
Selection	Evidence-based recommendation and final approval.
Verification	Required checks completed and reviewed appropriately.
Offer	Approved written offer and recorded candidate response.
Handover	Accepted offer and controlled onboarding handover.

20. SOP Governance and Review

The Human Resources Department owns this SOP and is responsible for maintaining the current controlled version, communicating process changes, and coordinating periodic reviews. Process owners should retain evidence that required approvals and recruitment controls were completed.

This SOP should be reviewed when recruitment systems, organizational structures, applicable requirements, or hiring governance materially change. Updates must be approved by the designated HR authority before publication.

Document control: HR-SOP-001 | Version 1.0 | Effective 04 November 2026 | Access Scope: ADMIN_ONLY | Owner: Human Resources

Demo notice: Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is a fictional company used for demonstration and OnBoardIQ document-ingestion testing. This SOP is illustrative and does not constitute legal advice or an approved corporate hiring procedure.